

Political & Cultural Context

Minority ethnic communities in Wales — with a focus on the Chinese community

The moderation agent cannot judge whether a message is hostile, in-group, or safe to publish without knowing the world the message lives in. This document supplies that world: the Welsh political and legislative context the partner communities navigate, the demographic and community landscape of minority ethnic Wales, who Race Council Cymru and the Chinese in Wales Association are, and the specific cultural and political sensitivities — especially within the Chinese community — that determine how the same words can read as solidarity or as attack. It serves both the **decision-support agent** (which must consult it to *contextualise a message based on the community*) and the **community stewards** who govern the tool.

Document	Political & Cultural Context — Corpus Material 2 of 4
Maps to	Layer 1 retrieval corpus → Community & organisational context index (High priority, 10 files)
Serves	The LPA decision-support agent and community stewards at Race Council Cymru and the Chinese in Wales Association
Scope	Minority ethnic communities in Wales / UK, with a focus on the Chinese and East/Southeast Asian community
Feeds	Contextualising incoming content; the pre-publication dual-audience branch; retrieval-grounded explainability
Status	Draft baseline for community validation — stewards are the authority on their own communities

Read first — whose knowledge this is

This document is compiled from public sources **about** these communities; it is not the communities' own account of themselves. Under the LPA framework the corpus is community-curated and contestable, so every section here is a **starting draft for stewards to correct, deepen or delete**. Communities are internally diverse and never speak with one voice; nothing below should be read as a fixed or complete description of any person or group. It is offered so the agent has enough grounding to ask better questions and defer to the steward — not so it can substitute its own judgement for the community's.

Neutrality note. This document describes contested political topics (immigration policy in Wales; politics within the Chinese and Hong Kong diaspora). It sets out the range of views as context only and takes no side, consistent with the framework's neutrality constraint. All content is paraphrased and attributed; no source text is reproduced verbatim.

00 How this document fits the corpus

Corpus Material 1 covered the platforms' rules and UK / Wales law. This second entry covers the human context those rules are applied within. In the framework's own terms, the community & organisational context index gives the agent the reference evidence it needs to *contextualise a message based on the community* — to read tone, target and framing the way a community member would, rather than the way a majority-default classifier does.

It is written to support three concrete moments in the framework:

- **Interpreting incoming content.** Whether a phrase is a slur, a reclaimed in-group term, a dog-whistle, or ordinary criticism often depends on who is speaking to whom, and on live political sensitivities. The context here lets the agent surface those possibilities and hand the judgement to a steward.
- **The pre-publication dual-audience branch.** The partner organisations act as a bridge between government and community, and a sentence that reassures one audience can read as betrayal to the other. Sections on the Welsh political landscape and the 'bridge' tension exist to support that check.
- **Setting boundaries.** The framework asks the corpus to encode a community's *own boundaries*. The guidance section sets out what the agent must not assume or do — never flattening a diverse community into one position, and never taking a side on contested diaspora politics.

A note on terminology

Terms for these communities are themselves contested and change over time. Welsh Government policy currently uses 'Black, Asian and Minority Ethnic' and 'ethnic minority'; the 2021 Census added 'Asian Welsh' and 'Black Welsh' categories for the first time; and 'East and Southeast Asian (ESEA)' is widely used by that community's own networks. This document mirrors the term used by each source and defers to how community members describe themselves. Labels should be treated as an editable corpus decision, not a fixed given.

Wales is a nation with its own devolved parliament and a distinct policy direction on race and migration that often differs from Westminster's. This shapes both what the partner organisations can call on and the political weather their communities live in.

Devolution and the Senedd

Since 1999 Wales has had a devolved legislature — the Senedd (Welsh Parliament) — and a Welsh Government. Areas such as health, housing, education, the Welsh language and community cohesion are devolved, so Wales sets its own course there. Crucially, **immigration and asylum policy are reserved to the UK Government**, which is why Welsh initiatives operate through devolved levers (housing, language, education, integration) rather than by controlling who enters the country. For a moderation tool, this split matters: a community statement addressed to 'government' may mean the Welsh Government, a local authority, or Westminster, and the three have very different powers and postures.

An anti-racist Wales by 2030

The Welsh Government has committed to becoming an **anti-racist nation by 2030** through its Anti-racist Wales Action Plan (ArWAP), first published in 2022, refreshed in 2024, with a progress update in early 2026. The plan was co-produced with people with lived experience and grew partly out of findings that structural racism contributed to the disproportionate impact of COVID-19 on ethnic minority people, and out of calls from the Wales Race Forum. It targets institutional and structural racism across government, education, health, housing and justice, and includes specific commitments on Gypsy, Roma and Traveller communities and on the Welsh language. For the agent, ArWAP is the policy frame a community message may invoke or hold government to.

Nation of Sanctuary

Launched in 2019, the Welsh Government's Nation of Sanctuary initiative aims for Wales to be the world's first 'nation of sanctuary' for refugees and asylum seekers, offering integration support such as subsidised transport and English and Welsh language education, and endorsed by the United Nations. Because immigration is reserved, it works through devolved services. It is politically contested: broadly supported by Welsh Labour and Plaid Cymru and criticised by Reform UK and the Welsh Conservatives. Most people supported since 2019 have been Ukrainians, alongside refugees from Hong Kong and Afghanistan. The agent should treat both the policy and the argument around it as live context, and stay neutral on the dispute.

The Welsh language and 'croeso'

Wales is officially bilingual, and the Welsh language (Cymraeg) is woven through public life and identity; the value of *croeso* (welcome) is frequently invoked in Welsh civic culture. Community-facing communications may need to work in Welsh and English at once, and a message's reception can carry a Welsh-identity dimension as well as an ethnic one. Anti-racism and the Welsh language are treated as connected, not competing, in Welsh policy.

Sources (accessed 8 July 2026): *Anti-racist Wales Action Plan and 2024 update* (gov.wales/anti-racist-wales); *Senedd Research on ArWAP*; *Nation of Sanctuary* (gov.wales); *Welsh Refugee Council*; *contemporary reporting*. *Devolution / reserved matters*: *Senedd and UK Government guidance*. *Well-being of Future Generations (Wales) Act 2015*.

Wales is less ethnically diverse than England overall, but its minority ethnic communities are long-established, growing, and concentrated in the south-east cities. The 2021 Census gives the baseline (figures are self-identification on Census Day, 21 March 2021).

3.11m usual residents in Wales (2021)	93.8% identified as 'White' (95.6% in 2011)	2.9% Asian, Asian Welsh or Asian British	0.9% Black, Black Welsh, British, Caribbean or African
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Beyond the headline 'White' figure, around 89,000 people identified as Asian, Asian Welsh or Asian British, 49,000 as Mixed or multiple, 28,000 as Black (and Black Welsh etc.), and 26,000 as another ethnic group — all rising since 2011. The 2021 Census added **Asian Welsh** and **Black Welsh** categories for the first time, reflecting people who claim both a minority ethnic and a Welsh identity. Just over half of Wales's residents (55.2%) reported a Welsh-only national identity.

Where communities are

Diversity is concentrated in the south-east urban centres. Cardiff is the most diverse local authority (around one in ten residents Asian, and the highest shares Black, Mixed and Other), with Newport second and Swansea third; Wrexham and Cardiff also have notable 'Other White' populations. Cardiff's Butetown (historically Tiger Bay) is one of the UK's oldest multi-ethnic dockland communities, home to long-settled Somali, Yemeni and other seafaring-descended families. Gypsy, Roma and Traveller communities and a growing Roma population (notably in Newport) are also part of the picture, as are refugees and asylum seekers supported through Nation of Sanctuary.

An ecosystem of community organisations

Minority ethnic Wales is served by a dense network of civil-society organisations that a moderation tool sits alongside. The Senedd's Cross-Party Group on Race Equality alone brings together bodies such as the Muslim Council of Wales, the Yemeni community, EYST, the Welsh Refugee Council, BAWSO, Race Equality First, the Romani Cultural and Arts Company, Travelling Ahead (Gypsy, Roma and Traveller advocacy), the African Community Centre, and the Chinese in Wales Association — with Race Council Cymru providing the secretariat. This matters for context: these communities are distinct, differently situated, and often represented by their own specialist organisations.

Sources (accessed 8 July 2026): *Ethnic group, national identity, language and religion in Wales, Census 2021 (gov.wales; ONS; StatsWales); Senedd Research summaries of Census 2021; Senedd Cross-Party Group on Race & Equality membership; community-organisation public information.*

03 The partner organisations

Race Council Cymru (RCC)

What it is	An umbrella body established in 2010 that brings together and represents a large number of Black, Asian and minority ethnic organisations across Wales (its own materials cite figures around 180–250 member groups).
Mission	To bring key organisations together to promote integration, champion justice, and advance race equality in Welsh institutions and society — working with grassroots communities and with government, local authorities and other bodies.
What it runs	Regional Ethnic Minority Hubs (including Newport, Cardiff & Vale, Swansea, Carmarthenshire and North Wales); Windrush Cymru Elders; Black History Wales / Black History Cymru 365; the Zero Racism Wales pledge; and youth structures such as the National Minority Ethnic Youth Forum for Wales.
Its role here	RCC is both a representative voice for minority ethnic communities across Wales and a bridge to government, which is exactly the ‘dual-audience’ position the pre-publication branch is built around.

Chinese in Wales Association (CIWA)

What it is	A community-led, grassroots UK-registered charity (charity no. 1175444), established in 2017, with its head office in Swansea, dedicated to improving the lives of people of Chinese heritage across Wales.
What it provides	Multilingual counselling (Mandarin, Cantonese, Hakka and English); Chinese-language welfare and benefits advice and casework advocacy; activities for older people (50+) to counter isolation; youth activities; a Chinese Autism Support Group; digital-inclusion work; and the ‘Our Stories’ oral-history project with Swansea University and national cultural institutions.
What it signals	CIWA’s service mix — counselling, benefits advice, anti-isolation work, multilingual delivery — maps the community’s real pressure points: language barriers, older-person isolation, and wellbeing. These are the boundaries around what ‘help’ should look like.
Its role here	As a delivery partner in the framework, CIWA is the authority on the Chinese-community context in this document and the steward best placed to correct and extend it.

Both organisations sit inside the same civic network

Race Council Cymru and the Chinese in Wales Association are linked through Wales’s race-equality infrastructure — both take part in the Senedd Cross-Party Group on Race Equality, and RCC’s founder has served on CIWA’s board. The agent should treat them as collaborating stewards representing overlapping but distinct constituencies: RCC speaks broadly for minority ethnic Wales; CIWA speaks specifically for the Chinese community. Where their guidance differs, defer to the organisation closest to the affected community.

Sources (accessed 8 July 2026): Race Council Cymru (racecouncilcymru.org.uk) and programme pages; Chinese in Wales Association (chineseinwales.org.uk); UK Charity Commission / Companies House record (CE011908, charity 1175444); Peoples Collection Wales ‘Our Stories’ project; Senedd Cross-Party Group membership.

04 The Chinese & ESEA community in Wales

The Chinese community is one of Wales's oldest minority ethnic communities and one of its most internally varied. Understanding that internal variety is essential to contextualising any message about, to, or from it.

A long and dispersed history

Chinese migration to Wales stretches back roughly a century, with the largest waves arriving from the 1940s to the 1970s, mainly from Hong Kong and Guangdong, and settling into the catering and laundry trades. Because that work spread families across towns rather than concentrating them in one district, the community became geographically dispersed — a pattern that still drives the isolation, especially of older people, that CIWA works to address. Concentrations exist in Cardiff, Swansea, Newport and Wrexham. Many British-born or Welsh-born Chinese people also navigate questions of identity and language continuity across generations.

Internal diversity: language, origin and generation

'Chinese' in Wales spans several languages and heritages. Older, long-settled families are often Cantonese- or Hakka-speaking with roots in Hong Kong and Guangdong; since around 2000 a growing number of students and skilled migrants have come from mainland China, and Mandarin has become the dominant language of the community. Malaysian, Vietnamese and other Chinese-heritage backgrounds are also present. The community is therefore multilingual and multi-generational, and a message that resonates with one segment may not reach or may even alienate another.

The Hong Kong BN(O) wave

A recent and significant addition is Hong Kong arrivals on the British National (Overseas) visa, a route the UK opened on 31 January 2021 following the imposition of the National Security Law in Hong Kong. BN(O) holders have a path to settlement (the first cohort became eligible around January 2026) but arrive with a 'no recourse to public funds' condition, and the route was expanded in February 2026 to more adult children. Many are Cantonese-speaking and left Hong Kong for political reasons. Their arrival adds both linguistic and political diversity to the existing community — and, as the next section explains, new internal sensitivities.

Sources (accessed 8 July 2026): Community histories and demographic summaries (Chinese in Wales Association; local heritage and school resources; 2011 Census figures for Wales, 2021 Census figures for England & Wales); Wales Strategic Migration Partnership, 'Building a New Life in Wales: Hong Kong BN(O) Visa Holders Welcome'; GOV.UK and House of Commons Library on the BN(O) route.

These are the fault lines most likely to change how a message is read — the points where an agent operating on majority-default assumptions will misjudge tone, target or risk.

Do not conflate the community with a state

A recurring harm reported by the Chinese and wider ESEA community is being treated as interchangeable with the Chinese government — blamed for its actions, for COVID-19, or cast as suspect by association. Conflating a diverse diaspora with ‘China’ the state is itself a form of hostility, and it is distinct from legitimate criticism of a government’s policies. The agent should hold that distinction carefully: criticism of a state is not the same as an attack on people of that heritage, and vice versa.

Diaspora politics are contested and sensitive

The community does not hold a single political position. Topics including Hong Kong, the National Security Law, Taiwan, Tibet, Xinjiang and the events of 1989 are live and sometimes painful fault lines, and views differ sharply between, for example, recent pro-democracy Hong Kong arrivals and other segments of the community. Some diaspora members also report anxiety about surveillance or pressure reaching them from abroad. The agent must remain strictly neutral on these questions, avoid assuming any individual’s stance from their heritage, and recognise that a comment that is ordinary politics to one community member may feel threatening to another.

The ‘model minority’ myth and invisibility

ESEA communities are often stereotyped as a quiet, uniformly successful ‘model minority’, and are frequently rendered statistically invisible — folded into aggregate categories that obscure specific harms. Both dynamics lead to their experiences being dismissed or under-counted, which is part of why coded anti-ESEA hostility is under-detected (see Corpus Material 1). Treating this community as ‘low-risk by default’ would repeat that error.

The bridge between government and community

The partner organisations routinely speak to two audiences at once: government partners who expect measured, policy-oriented language, and community members who expect their experiences named plainly. Wording that reassures one can read as betrayal to the other — the exact risk the pre-publication branch checks. Contextualising outgoing content means testing it against both readings, not one.

Reclaimed language, religion and the Welsh dimension

- **Reclaimed / in-group language.** Across these communities, terms used affectionately or reclaimed within a group can look hostile to outsiders and to automated tools; intent and speaker matter, and the steward is the arbiter.
- **Religion is a distinct axis.** Minority ethnic Wales includes large Muslim communities (and the framework’s own analysis found anti-religious hostility is often implicit and under-moderated), so race and religion should be treated as related but separate grounds.
- **The Welsh-language dimension.** Messages may carry a Welsh-identity as well as an ethnic dimension, and may need to hold up bilingually; a phrase’s connotation can differ across languages.

Context is not static. The following recent dynamics shape what hostility looks like now and how outgoing community messages are likely to be received. Stewards should update this section as events move.

Post-2024 disorder: Wales differed, but was not immune

The racist disorder that spread across parts of England in summer 2024 largely did not take the same form in Wales; where small far-right gatherings occurred they were typically met by larger counter-demonstrations welcoming refugees. But Wales was not untouched: there have been protests outside hotels earmarked for asylum accommodation (for example in Llanelli), and Welsh Government ministers noted a rise in racial hatred and threats in the aftermath of the English disorder and amid the Middle East conflict. The lesson for the agent is that national calm does not mean local safety, and heightened-tension periods raise the stakes of both incoming hostility and outgoing wording.

A concrete online-to-offline harm: the Welsh Refugee Council case

In early 2026 the Welsh Refugee Council reported having to pause services after a defamatory post shared by a high-profile figure on X falsely accused the charity of wrongdoing, leading to harassment of its staff and volunteers. It is a clear illustration of how a single high-reach post can translate into real-world harm for Welsh minority-serving organisations — the kind of pre-publication and incoming-content risk the framework exists to help stewards anticipate.

June 2026: the Northern Ireland (Belfast) riots

In June 2026 the pattern returned in more violent form. After a stabbing in North Belfast on 8 June — for which a Sudanese man with legal refugee status was charged — anti-immigrant riots broke out across Belfast on 9–10 June and spread elsewhere in Northern Ireland and to cities in Scotland and England. Rioters went door-to-door trying to identify homes occupied by immigrants, setting properties, vehicles and a bus alight; around 27 people, including a family with a baby, were made homeless, and police declared a critical incident and deployed water cannon. The Times and the Irish Times described the violence as a ‘pogrom’, and political leaders across Northern Ireland, including First Minister Michelle O’Neill, condemned it.

Two features make it directly relevant to this corpus. First, the online-incitement dimension: a graphic video of the attack was amplified by high-profile figures, and lists of addresses said to house immigrants were circulated on social media — which police warned could itself be a criminal offence. Second, the regulatory response: Ofcom wrote to online platforms stating the unrest appeared to have been incited online, reminded them of their Online Safety Act duties, and said it had already opened investigations into several services (see Corpus Material 1). Although the violence was in Northern Ireland, the same online dynamics — viral incitement, coordinated amplification, and the sharing of targets’ addresses — reach minority communities in Wales, and events like these sharply raise the temperature for the partner communities. For the agent, it is a stark example of how incoming-content and disinformation risks can escalate into physical danger.

Contested immigration politics

Immigration and the Nation of Sanctuary have become sharply contested in Welsh politics, with rising support for Reform UK reported ahead of the 2026 Senedd election and vocal disagreement in the Senedd itself. Anti-migrant and anti-refugee narratives — including long, polite-sounding arguments that a group does not belong — are part of the current landscape. The agent should present this as genuinely contested political terrain, distinguish criticism of policy from attacks on people, and stay neutral on the underlying dispute.

A persisting COVID-era legacy for ESEA communities

Although the pandemic's peak has passed, the coded anti-East/Southeast-Asian hostility it amplified — disease- and 'bat-eating' tropes, blame framing, and the pairing of ESEA faces with negative stories — established patterns that persist in muted, coded forms. This is the material most likely to slip past automated detection, and where the community-curated evasion register earns its place.

Sources (accessed 8 July 2026): Contemporary reporting on Wales and the 2024 disorder, Nation of Sanctuary and Reform UK (e.g. *Big Issue*; *Nation.Cymru*; Welsh Government statements); Welsh Refugee Council public reporting; ESEA-community research and organisations cited in Corpus Material 1. 2026 Northern Ireland (Belfast) riots: Wikipedia '2026 Northern Ireland riots'; Al Jazeera; CNN; NPR; Ofcom statements (June 2026). Political claims are presented as contested context, not endorsed positions.

How the agent and stewards should apply the material above. These are operating principles, not a script; the steward always makes the final call.

For interpreting incoming content

- Read for speaker and target, not just words: the same term can be an attack, a reclaimed in-group usage, or ordinary criticism depending on who says it to whom.
- Separate the state from the people: treat criticism of a government as distinct from hostility toward people of that heritage, and flag conflation of the two as a possible harm.
- Expect coded forms for ESEA hostility and check the evasion register; do not treat this community as low-risk by default.
- Surface possibilities and cite the context entry; where the reading turns on community-specific knowledge, defer to the steward rather than deciding.

For the pre-publication dual-audience branch

- Test outgoing wording against both a government reading and a community reading, and name where they diverge.
- Clarify which 'government' is meant — Welsh Government, local authority or Westminster — because their powers and postures differ.
- Consider whether the message needs to work bilingually and whether connotations shift between Welsh and English.

Boundaries — what the agent must not do

Do not flatten a diverse community into a single position, or infer an individual's politics, religion or stance from their heritage. Do not take a side on contested diaspora or immigration politics. Do not 'unpack' or speculate about a person's lived experience. Do not treat this document as the community's own voice or as complete. When a judgement depends on community-specific knowledge the corpus does not contain, say so and escalate to a human steward rather than guessing — consistent with the framework's consent-to-escalate and uncertainty-surfacing constraints.

Steward maintenance checklist

- Validate every section against lived community knowledge; correct, deepen or remove as needed — stewards are the authority here, not the compilers.
- Refresh the current-climate section regularly; political weather (elections, disorder, diaspora events) moves faster than the rest of the document.
- Keep terminology aligned with how community members currently describe themselves.
- Add community-specific coded terms and sensitivities to the evasion register and to Corpus Material 1's harm mapping as they emerge.
- Re-verify demographic figures against the latest Census / StatsWales releases.
- Record a change history so the audit trail shows which community decision authorised each edit.

Provenance

Compiled from Welsh Government and Senedd sources (Anti-racist Wales Action Plan; Nation of Sanctuary; Census 2021 via gov.wales, ONS and StatsWales), the partner organisations' own public materials, the Wales Strategic Migration Partnership and House of Commons Library on the BN(O) route, and reputable contemporary reporting on the current political climate. Content about diaspora politics and immigration is presented as contested context. All content is paraphrased; source URLs are listed at the foot of each section.

Disclaimer

This is external, public-source context to support community moderation, not the communities' own self-definition, and not legal or political advice. Communities are internally diverse and evolving; no description here is fixed or complete. The authoritative account of any community is that community itself, represented through its stewards, who may revise this document at any time.

End of Corpus Material 2 of 4 — Political & Cultural Context. Companion: (1) Platform Terms & Policies. Next: (3) Glossary of tech and popular terms; (4) Persona categories.